

comments that come in, you may choose the notification settings as well as the comment approval settings. I would recommend a notification every time a comment is made, irrespective of whether it is approved or not. (Check both). With regards to approval, the usual method is to allow the moderator to check whether it is valid and then authenticate it. Though Akismet does a decent level of filtering, a lot of people still use manual blog marketing to insert an inane comment and then advertise their sites.

h. Alternatively, you may choose to approve all comments by an individual whose comment has been accepted before.

i. You can also set up filters based on comments containing certain words or links to certain sites. These will come up for moderation. You can limit the number of links or choose inline text filtering. Please note that WordPress searches within the text and does not do whole word matching. So if you're filtering for "sex", a comment having "sensex" will get flagged for moderation

j. You can also set up filters for spam

k. You may choose to allow comments via email, allow a person to subscribe to the comments (in case of a really interesting conversation with several comments) and an option to subscribe to the blog.

l. Now, an Avatar is an identity given to the user based on his email ID. I will not go into the whole MD5 encryption and other details, but it's sufficient to know that it creates a nice icon next to the commenter. Depending on the WordPress plugin that you use for allowing Avatars, a picture will appear next to the commenter. A Wavatar generates a funny cartoon, a Gravatar is a Globally Recognized Avatar (you can create one for yourself with your picture etc). Check the tag next to the option to check whether the user needs one, or if your blog will generate it.

m. You have the choice of allowing the Maximum Rating. (This is limited to the Gravatar option – if you don't want Gravatars with explicit pictures)

Media Settings:

Media Settings require little or no explanation.

a. To those of you who tried inserting a picture in the earlier chapter, you would know that you have a choice of inserting the picture as-is, as a thumbnail, medium size or large size. This allows you to configure those sizes in pixels. (You can of course, change this once the picture has been inserted. Hover over the picture, top left has options. Click to resize by percentage)

b. Allowing Auto-embeds is useful. This allows you to embed videos, pictures, documents from various websites. Just leave the default settings on